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Your invitation to Thamesmead's 50th Birthday Festival. Resident information for Saturday 14 July 2018

Dear resident,

We are writing to invite you to Thamesmead's 50th Birthday Festival taking place in **Southmere Park and Southmere Square from 12pm – 7pm on Saturday 14th July 2018**. Exactly 50 years ago in July 1968, the first residents moved into Coraline Walk and we want to celebrate Thamesmead's 50th birthday with a community celebration for everyone.

Following the success of the Thamesmead festival last year, we have worked with a group of local residents on our festival steering group to guide what we include in this year's festival. Some of these residents are from the Southmere area.

50th Birthday Festival in Southmere Park 12pm – 7pm
The festival will start with a community carnival of local school children and local community groups who will enter from the Ridgeway (north of the Lake) and will arrive in Southmere Park at 1pm.
The main festival site will be situated on the hill next to Southmere Lake. It will be a fun day for all the family and activities will include a community music stage featuring local dance groups and choirs, a dog show, circus workshops, an area for children's activities and much more.
Towards the end of the day, at around 6.20pm, there will be some biodegradable confetti thrown as we enjoy the final band, and it promises to be quite a spectacle – do come and watch! The confetti will be made of organic, biodegradable paper which will not harm any pets or wildlife and will disappear in a few days.

Community Market Place, Southmere Square, 12pm – 7pm
This year we are spreading the festival into Southmere Square following several requests from residents to have activities in this space. There will be food and craft stalls run by local traders and a band stand playing low level music only. There will be a tea dance at 4pm which everyone is welcome to join in.

Peabody Trust, an exempt charity, Community Benefit Society, registration number 7223.
Homes and Community Agency registration number 4834.

Setting up and packing up
Friday 13th July - The festival team will begin setting up in both locations on Friday between 10am and 6pm. Care will be taken to cause as little noise and disruption as possible, and there will be overnight security in both areas from Friday to Saturday.
Saturday 14th July - The festival set up will continue on Saturday morning from 8am – 12 noon. The event will take place from 12 noon – 7pm. We will then remove all equipment between 7pm and 12 midnight on Saturday, again taking care to keep any disruption and noise to a minimum.

Parking
We are encouraging all visitors to park along Bazelgette Way and will put cones along Hartslock Drive and St Katherines Road as we did last year to deter parking.

Partners
The festival is being produced by Emergency Exit Arts (EEA) on behalf of Peabody. EEA is based locally in Greenwich and has been delivering outdoor shows and spectacles for over 30 years across the UK with their hugely experienced team. As well as event planning, EEA's priority is to make sure that all residents are informed about the festival and that disruption is kept to a minimum.

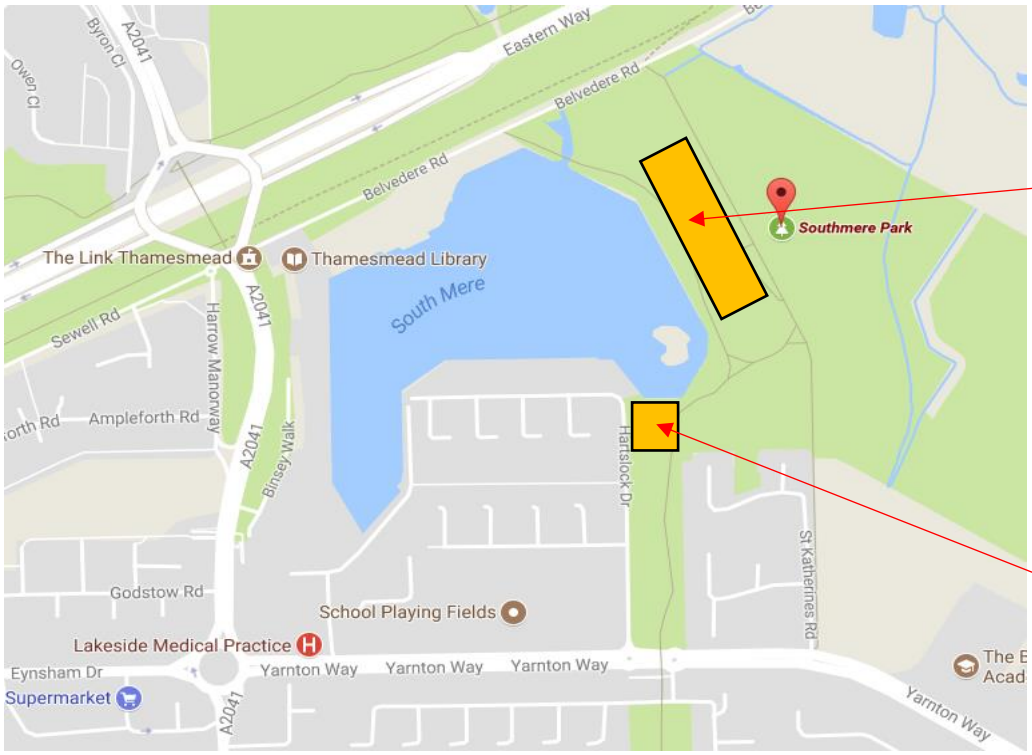
We do hope you will come along and help us celebrate Thamesmead's very special birthday. For more information visit: www.thamesmeadnow.org.uk

Contacts
If you have any questions or concerns regarding the event please contact:

- Festival Producer, Amaya Dent, T: 0208 853 4809 or
  E: Amaya.Dent@eea.org.uk
- Peabody contact, Adriana Marques, T: 0203 828 3869 or
  E: Adriana.Marques@peabody.org.uk

If you have any queries or concerns during the festival weekend, please contact me on the above number which will be redirected to my mobile.

Many thanks,
Adriana Marques
Head of Culture for Thamesmead



50th Birthday Festival main site with community stage and arrival of community carnival at 1pm

Community Market Place with local food vendors and bandstand with acoustic music.